

First Aid Procedures Guide

Emergency Response Basics

The ABCs of First Aid

- **A - Airway:** Ensure the airway is clear
- **B - Breathing:** Check if the person is breathing
- **C - Circulation:** Check for pulse and control bleeding

When to Call 911

- Unconsciousness or altered mental state
 - Difficulty breathing or no breathing
 - Chest pain or pressure
 - Severe bleeding
 - Suspected broken bones
 - Head, neck, or back injuries
 - Poisoning or overdose
 - Severe burns
 - Seizures
 - Severe allergic reactions
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CPR (Cardiopulmonary Resuscitation)

Adult CPR

1. Check Responsiveness

- Tap shoulders and shout "Are you okay?"
- Look for normal breathing
- Call 911 or have someone else call

2. Position the Person

- Place on firm, flat surface
- Tilt head back slightly to open airway

3. Chest Compressions

- Place heel of one hand on center of chest

- Place other hand on top, interlace fingers
- Position shoulders directly over hands
- Push hard and fast: 2 inches deep
- Rate: 100-120 compressions per minute
- Allow chest to fully recoil between compressions

4. Rescue Breaths (if trained)

- After 30 compressions, give 2 breaths
- Pinch nose, seal mouth over victim's mouth
- Each breath should last 1 second
- Watch for chest rise

5. Continue

- Repeat cycles of 30 compressions and 2 breaths
- Continue until help arrives or person starts breathing

Hands-Only CPR

- If untrained or uncomfortable with rescue breaths
- Perform continuous chest compressions
- Push hard and fast in center of chest
- Don't stop until help arrives

Infant CPR (Under 1 Year)

Differences from Adult CPR:

- Use 2 fingers for compressions
- Compress 1.5 inches deep
- Give gentler breaths (just enough to see chest rise)
- Ratio: 30 compressions to 2 breaths (one rescuer)

Choking

Conscious Adult/Child Choking

Signs:

- Cannot speak or cough
- Clutching throat (universal choking sign)
- Turning blue
- Wheezing or high-pitched sounds

Heimlich Maneuver:

1. Stand behind the person
2. Make a fist with one hand
3. Place fist above navel, below ribcage
4. Grasp fist with other hand
5. Give quick, upward thrusts
6. Repeat until object is expelled or person becomes unconscious

If Person Becomes Unconscious:

- Lower person to ground
- Call 911
- Begin CPR
- Before giving breaths, look in mouth for object

Infant Choking (Under 1 Year)

Back Blows and Chest Thrusts:

1. Support infant face-down on your forearm
 2. Give 5 firm back blows between shoulder blades
 3. Turn infant face-up
 4. Give 5 chest thrusts with 2 fingers
 5. Repeat until object is expelled
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Bleeding Control

Minor Cuts and Scrapes

Steps:

1. Wash hands thoroughly
2. Rinse wound with clean water
3. Apply gentle pressure with clean cloth
4. Clean around wound with soap
5. Apply antibiotic ointment
6. Cover with bandage
7. Change bandage daily

Severe Bleeding

Steps:

1. Call 911 for severe bleeding
2. Protect yourself (wear gloves if available)
3. Have person lie down
4. Remove obvious debris (don't probe wound)
5. Apply firm, direct pressure with clean cloth
6. Maintain pressure for 10-15 minutes
7. Add more cloth if blood soaks through (don't remove first cloth)
8. Elevate injured area above heart if possible
9. Apply pressure bandage when bleeding slows

Tourniquet (Last Resort):

- Only if bleeding is life-threatening and direct pressure fails
- Apply 2-3 inches above wound
- Tighten until bleeding stops
- Note time of application
- Do not loosen once applied

Nosebleeds

Steps:

1. Sit upright, lean slightly forward
2. Pinch soft part of nose
3. Hold for 10 minutes without releasing
4. Breathe through mouth
5. Apply ice pack to bridge of nose
6. Avoid blowing nose for several hours

Seek Medical Attention If:

- Bleeding doesn't stop after 20 minutes
- Caused by injury to head or face
- Difficulty breathing
- Swallowing large amounts of blood

Burns

First-Degree Burns (Superficial)

- **Symptoms:** Redness, pain, mild swelling
- **Treatment:**
 1. Cool burn with running water (10-20 minutes)
 2. Apply aloe vera or moisturizer

3. Cover with sterile, non-stick bandage
4. Take over-the-counter pain reliever

Second-Degree Burns (Partial Thickness)

- **Symptoms:** Blisters, severe pain, red/splotchy skin
- **Treatment:**
 1. Cool with running water (do not use ice)
 2. Don't break blisters
 3. Apply antibiotic ointment
 4. Cover with sterile, non-stick bandage
 5. Seek medical attention if larger than 3 inches

Third-Degree Burns (Full Thickness)

- **Symptoms:** White/charred skin, numbness
- **Treatment:**
 1. Call 911 immediately
 2. Don't remove burned clothing stuck to skin
 3. Cover with clean, dry cloth
 4. Don't apply ointments or ice
 5. Elevate burned area
 6. Monitor for shock

Chemical Burns

1. Call 911 or poison control
2. Remove contaminated clothing
3. Flush with water for 20+ minutes
4. Don't apply ointments
5. Cover with sterile bandage

Electrical Burns

1. Don't touch person if still in contact with electricity
2. Turn off power source if safe
3. Call 911
4. Check for breathing and pulse
5. Begin CPR if needed

Fractures and Sprains

Suspected Fracture

Signs:

- Severe pain
- Swelling and bruising
- Deformity or abnormal position
- Inability to move or bear weight
- Bone protruding through skin (open fracture)

Treatment:

1. Call 911 for severe fractures
2. Don't move injured area
3. Immobilize with splint if trained
4. Apply ice pack (wrapped in cloth)
5. Elevate if possible
6. Monitor for shock

Open Fracture:

- Don't push bone back in
- Cover wound with sterile dressing
- Control bleeding with gentle pressure
- Immobilize area
- Call 911 immediately

Sprains and Strains

RICE Method:

- **R - Rest:** Avoid using injured area
- **I - Ice:** Apply for 20 minutes every 2-3 hours (first 48 hours)
- **C - Compression:** Wrap with elastic bandage (not too tight)
- **E - Elevation:** Raise above heart level

Seek Medical Attention If:

- Severe pain or swelling
- Cannot bear weight
- Numbness or tingling
- No improvement after 48 hours

Head Injuries

Concussion Warning Signs

- Loss of consciousness
- Confusion or disorientation
- Headache
- Nausea or vomiting
- Dizziness
- Blurred vision
- Sensitivity to light/noise
- Memory problems

Treatment

1. Call 911 for severe head injuries
2. Keep person still
3. Don't move if neck/spine injury suspected
4. Apply ice to swelling
5. Monitor for worsening symptoms
6. Don't give medications without medical advice
7. Don't allow person to sleep immediately (monitor first)

Seek Immediate Medical Attention If:

- Loss of consciousness
- Repeated vomiting
- Seizures
- Severe headache
- Unequal pupil size
- Slurred speech
- Weakness or numbness

Shock

Signs and Symptoms

- Pale, cold, clammy skin
- Rapid, weak pulse
- Rapid breathing
- Confusion or anxiety
- Weakness or fatigue
- Nausea
- Dilated pupils

Treatment

1. Call 911
 2. Lay person down
 3. Elevate legs 12 inches (unless head, neck, back, or leg injury)
 4. Keep person warm with blanket
 5. Don't give anything to eat or drink
 6. Turn head to side if vomiting
 7. Monitor breathing and pulse
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Allergic Reactions

Mild Allergic Reaction

- Itching, hives
- Mild swelling
- Runny nose

Treatment:

- Remove allergen if possible
- Give antihistamine (Benadryl)
- Apply cool compress to hives
- Monitor for worsening

Severe Allergic Reaction (Anaphylaxis)

Signs:

- Difficulty breathing
- Swelling of face, lips, tongue
- Rapid pulse
- Dizziness or fainting
- Nausea or vomiting
- Hives or rash

Treatment:

1. Call 911 immediately
2. Use epinephrine auto-injector (EpiPen) if available
 - Remove safety cap
 - Press firmly against outer thigh
 - Hold for 10 seconds
3. Have person lie down

4. Elevate legs
 5. Be prepared to perform CPR
 6. Second dose may be needed after 5-15 minutes
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Poisoning

General Steps

1. Call Poison Control: 1-800-222-1222
2. Have information ready:
 - Person's age and weight
 - Substance ingested
 - Amount and time
 - Symptoms

Swallowed Poison

- Don't induce vomiting unless directed
- Don't give anything to eat or drink unless directed
- Save container or substance

Inhaled Poison

- Move person to fresh air immediately
- Call 911
- Begin CPR if needed

Skin Contact

- Remove contaminated clothing
- Flush skin with water for 20 minutes
- Call Poison Control

Eye Contact

- Flush with lukewarm water for 20 minutes
 - Don't rub eyes
 - Seek medical attention
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Seizures

What to Do

1. Stay calm
2. Time the seizure
3. Protect from injury:
 - Move dangerous objects away
 - Cushion head
 - Loosen tight clothing
4. Turn on side when jerking stops
5. Stay until fully conscious

What NOT to Do

- Don't restrain the person
- Don't put anything in mouth
- Don't give food, water, or medications until fully alert

Call 911 If:

- Seizure lasts more than 5 minutes
- Second seizure follows immediately
- Person is injured, pregnant, or diabetic
- First-time seizure
- Difficulty breathing after seizure
- Seizure occurs in water

Heat-Related Emergencies

Heat Exhaustion

Symptoms:

- Heavy sweating
- Weakness
- Nausea
- Headache
- Dizziness

Treatment:

1. Move to cool place
2. Loosen clothing
3. Apply cool, wet cloths
4. Sip water slowly

5. Rest

Heat Stroke (EMERGENCY)

Symptoms:

- High body temperature ($>103^{\circ}\text{F}$)
- Hot, dry skin or profuse sweating
- Confusion
- Loss of consciousness
- Seizures

Treatment:

1. Call 911 immediately
 2. Move to cool place
 3. Cool person rapidly:
 - Immerse in cool water, or
 - Apply ice packs to neck, armpits, groin
 4. Don't give fluids if unconscious
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Cold-Related Emergencies

Frostbite

Symptoms:

- Numbness
- White or grayish skin
- Hard or waxy skin
- Blisters

Treatment:

1. Move to warm place
2. Don't walk on frostbitten feet
3. Immerse in warm (not hot) water ($98\text{-}105^{\circ}\text{F}$)
4. Don't rub or massage area
5. Seek medical attention

Hypothermia

Symptoms:

- Shivering

- Confusion
- Slurred speech
- Drowsiness
- Weak pulse

Treatment:

1. Call 911
2. Move to warm place
3. Remove wet clothing
4. Warm center of body first (chest, neck, head)
5. Give warm beverages if conscious
6. Don't apply direct heat

First Aid Kit Essentials

Basic Supplies

- Adhesive bandages (various sizes)
- Sterile gauze pads
- Adhesive tape
- Elastic bandages
- Scissors
- Tweezers
- Safety pins
- Disposable gloves
- Antiseptic wipes
- Antibiotic ointment
- Hydrocortisone cream
- Pain relievers (acetaminophen, ibuprofen)
- Antihistamine
- Thermometer
- CPR face shield
- Emergency blanket
- First aid manual
- Emergency contact numbers

Important Reminders

⚠ **Medical Disclaimer:** This guide provides general first aid information. It does not replace professional medical training or emergency medical services. Always call 911 for serious emergencies.

☐ **Emergency Numbers:**

- 911: Emergency services
- 1-800-222-1222: Poison Control

- ☐ **Get Trained:** Consider taking a certified first aid and CPR course from organizations like the American Red Cross or American Heart Association.

Last Updated: 2026 Source: General first aid guidelines